

Transparent and opaque colors

It is important to understand the difference between opaque paint, which conceals the surface it is painted on, and transparent paint, which appears dark in a tube but transparent when painted thinly on a white surface. The transparent Permanent Rose shown here has been thinned gradually to show its true color, and then mixed with white to give opaque "tints." Black is then added to give a range of different "shades."



Permanent Rose, thinned down to its true color



If white paint is added, a range of opaque tints is produced



Touches of black mixed into the paint give dark shades

Recommended colors

The limited range of opaque [O] and transparent [T] colors (right) gives an extremely flexible palette, but add more colors if you wish. Recommended are all Cadmium and Mars colors, Light Red, Azo Red, Alizarin Crimson, Venetian Red, and Winsor Red, Arylamide or Azo Yellow, Manganese Blue, Cerulean Blue, Ultramarine Blue, Cobalt Blue, and Indanthrone Blue. Quinacridone (Violet), Dioxazine Violet, and Cobalt Violet are also good, as are Cobalt Green, Viridian, Terre Verte, Raw Sienna, Burnt Sienna, Flake White, Zinc White, Lamp Black, and Ivory Black.



Permanent Rose [T]
(Quinacridone Red)



Cadmium Red [O]



Cadmium Yellow
Pale [O]



Transparent Gold
Ochre [T]



Winsor Green [T]
(Phthalocyanine Green)



Winsor Blue [T]
(Phthalocyanine Blue)



Titanium White [O]



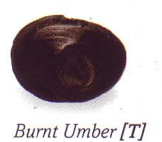
Oxide of Chromium [O]



Yellow Ochre [O]



Indian Red [O]



Burnt Umber [T]

Mixing primaries

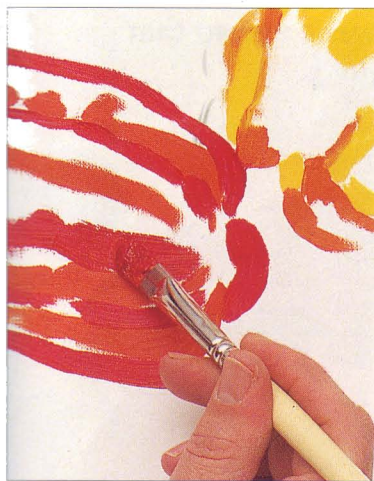
It is easy to assume that a mixture of two colors will simply produce a single third color. In fact, the two colors together can produce many versions of the third color, in a wide range of tones. A useful exercise is to try painting a simple still life, such as the one below, using a range of tones in a secondary color that you have mixed from two primaries.

PURE COLORS

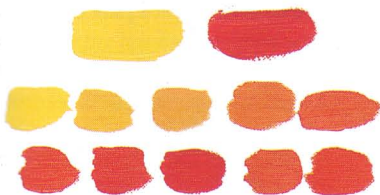


Use two jars of turpentine to first clean off excess paint, and then rinse the brush. This will retain the purity and strength of each color you use.

2 Use lighter tints of orange or yellow for highlights, and darker shades of orange or red for areas in shadow. The lightness or darkness of each orange mix creates a "tone" that models and shapes the peppers so they appear three-dimensional.



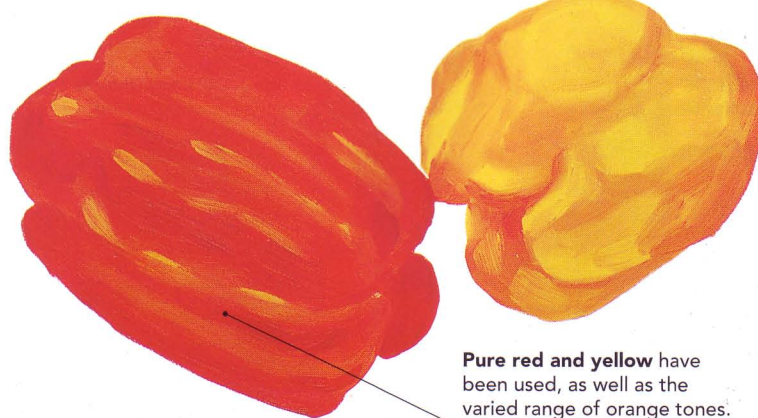
1 Before you paint these peppers, use a small scrap of posterboard and mix a range of different oranges from Permanent Rose and Cadmium Lemon (below). Then, with a clean medium-sized filbert bristle brush, paint the red pepper with shades of orange on a piece of oil paper.



Mix a range of orange tones before painting

Primary Peppers

These peppers look like real objects rather than flat images because a variety of different tints and shades create dimension and shape on each object. This range of clean orange tones has been achieved by carefully mixing different quantities of the primary colors red and yellow.



Pure red and yellow have been used, as well as the varied range of orange tones.